

AI Anthropomorphism Survey

Welcome to this Survey on AI use and anthropomorphism!

We would like to invite you to take part in a research study. Before you decide you need to understand why the research is being done and what it would involve for you. Please take time to read the following information carefully. Ask questions if anything you read is not clear or if you would like more information. **Take time to decide whether or not to take part.**

WHO WE ARE AND WHAT THIS STUDY IS ABOUT:

This study is being conducted by Roberto Sestini, an undergraduate at the London Interdisciplinary School. Your responses will help us understand the ways in which interaction with general-purpose LLMs affects anthropomorphism of LLMs, that is prescribing human characteristics, specially states of mind, to AI such as ChatGPT and Gemini.

WHAT DOES TAKING PART INVOLVE?

This survey is designed to be quick and easy to complete - it should take around **5-10 minutes** of your time and **all required questions are demographic information, multiple choice or Likert scales**. After answering the demographic questions you will outline your experience using LLMs, answer some questions to assess your understanding of how LLMs work, be assessed on your tendency to anthropomorphise generally and finally on your anthropomorphism of LLMs specifically.

WHY HAVE YOU BEEN INVITED TO TAKE PART?

Anyone over 18 qualifies for this study.

CONSENT INFORMATION: by agreeing to the below you are agreeing that:

- I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I am free to close the survey at any time before submitting, without giving any reason. I understand that if I do not provide a participant ID, my responses cannot be withdrawn after submission, as the researcher cannot identify which response is mine. I understand that I can withdraw at any time if I do provide a participant ID by emailing roberto.sestini@lis.ac.uk.
- I understand that information I provide in this survey will be used for the purposes of research, and that my responses will be anonymous.
- I understand that any personal data collected will be held securely, according to LIS guidelines and General Data Protection Regulations, and will be accessible only to the researcher named (Roberto Sestini) and understand that anonymised data collected during the research project may be looked at by responsible individuals from the London Interdisciplinary School to ensure that the research is conducted appropriately.
- I give permission for these individuals to have access to my research data and that anonymised data may be used in research publications and other outputs.

I confirm that I am 18 years of age or over and am resident in the United Kingdom

Consent + Participant ID

1. I consent to take part in this research having read the above information and confirm that I am a UK resident and over 18 years old. *

- ☐ I Agree
- ☐ I Disagree

2. If you might wish to withdraw your data, generate your Participant ID, take a note of it, and input it below.

Your Participant ID is the first two letters of your mother's first + day of birth (two digits) + first two letters of your birthplace.

e.g. someone who's mother is "Sandra", born on the 14th, from "Leeds" would be SA14LE

Demographics

3. How old are you? *

- ☐ 18-24
- ☐ 25-29
- ☐ 30-34
- ☐ 35-44
- ☐ 45-54
- ☐ 55-64
- ☐ 65+

4. What is your gender? *

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Non-binary
- ☐ Prefer not to say
- ☐ Other

5. What is the highest level of education you have completed? *

- ☐ Left school without qualifications
- ☐ GCSE/Standard grade
- ☐ A-level/Higher grade
- ☐ Certificate/Diploma/NVQ
- ☐ Degree
- ☐ Postgraduate
- ☐ Doctoral
- ☐ Other

6. What best describes your primary academic or professional background? *

- ☐ Business
- ☐ Humanities
- ☐ STEM
- ☐ Social sciences
- ☐ Arts
- ☐ Other

LLM Experience and Usage

For this survey the term "LLM" (Large Language Model) is frequently used. In general language this can be interchangeable with the term "AI"

The study also focuses specifically on general-purpose LLMs such as ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini as opposed to tailored agents such as [character.ai](#) and Replika.

All questions should therefore be interpreted as concerning only the use of general-purpose LLMs.

7. How often do you use a general-purpose LLMs such as ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini? *

- ☐ More than once a day
- ☐ Daily
- ☐ Multiple times a week
- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Monthly
- ☐ Less than once a month
- ☐ Never

8. How long have you been using LLMs regularly? *

- ☐ Less than 3 months
- ☐ 3-6 months
- ☐ 6-12 months
- ☐ 1-2 years
- ☐ More than 2 years

9. How long do you typically spend in a single session with an LLM? *

- ☐ Under 5 minutes
- ☐ 5-15 minutes
- ☐ 15-30 minutes
- ☐ 30-60 minutes
- ☐ 1-2 hours
- ☐ 2-3 hours
- ☐ 4+ hours

10. Which of the following general-purpose LLMs you have used in the past 3 months? Select all that apply. *

- ☐ Copilot
- ☐ Grok
- ☐ Mistral
- ☐ Gemini
- ☐ Claude
- ☐ ChatGPT
- ☐ Deepseek
- ☐ LLaMA
- ☐ Other

11. Which of the following best describes how you most commonly use LLMs? Select all that apply. *

- ☐ Coding
- ☐ Idea generation
- ☐ General conversation
- ☐ Learning or study
- ☐ Creative projects
- ☐ Information search
- ☐ Writing assistance
- ☐ Personal or emotional discussion
- ☐ Other

12. How often do you use LLMs for personal or emotionally significant conversations, as opposed to practical tasks? *

- ☐ Very often
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

13. When interacting with an LLM, how often do you use polite language such as "please" or "thank you"? *

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

14. What best describes your reason for using polite language? Select all that apply. *

- ☐ I am uncertain/believe that it matters to the LLM
- ☐ I think it may affect the quality of responses
- ☐ It is a habit from human conversation
- ☐ It feels uncomfortable not to

LLM Literacy

15. How does an LLM like ChatGPT primarily generate its responses? *

- ☐ By retrieving relevant information from a continuously updated database
- ☐ By predicting the most likely word or token based on patterns in training data
- ☐ By applying a structured set of logical rules to interpret and respond to input
- ☐ By searching and summarising content from the internet
- ☐ Don't know

16. True or false: ChatGPT remembers the content of previous conversations by default and uses this to inform future responses. *

- ☐ True
- ☐ False
- ☐ Don't know

17. True or false: an LLM will always give the same response to the same question. *

- ☐ True
- ☐ False
- ☐ Don't know

18. True or false: LLMs understand the meaning of language in the same way humans do. *

- ☐ True
- ☐ False
- ☐ Don't know

Individual Differences in Anthropomorphism Questionnaire (IDAQ)

The following questions ask about technology in general, not LLMs specifically.

Next, we will ask you to rate the extent to which you believe various stimuli (e.g. technological or mechanical items, wild and domestic animals, and natural things) possess certain capacities. On a 1-10 scale (where 1 = **“Not at All”** and 10 = **“Very much”**), please rate the extent to which the stimulus possesses the capacity given.

We will ask you about the extent to which the stimulus has a mind of its own, has free will, has intentions, has consciousness, can experience emotions,

By “has a mind of its own” we mean able to do what it wants.

By “can experience emotion” we mean it has feelings.

By “has consciousness” we mean able to be aware of itself and its thoughts and feelings.

19. To what extent does a cheetah experience emotions? *

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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20. To what extent does the average robot have consciousness? *

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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21. To what extent does the average insect have a mind of its own? *

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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22. To what extent does a television set experience emotions? *

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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23. To what extent does the average reptile have consciousness? *

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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24. To what extent does the average computer have a mind of its own? *

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Emotional and Relational Orientation

25. Social tendency *

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree	Strongly agree
I sometimes look forward to conversations with LLMs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have felt that an LLM understood me in a meaningful way.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

26. Perceived reciprocity *

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree	Strongly agree
When an LLM expresses interest in what I am saying, it feels genuine rather than mechanical.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I sometimes feel that an LLM is engaged with me as an individual rather than simply processing my input.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

27. Relationship substitution *

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree	Strongly agree
I have used an LLM for conversation or support when I would otherwise have talked to another person.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I find it easier to discuss certain topics with an LLM than with people I know.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Attribution of experience and agency

28. Experience *

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Agree	Strongly agree
LLMs are capable of having something like subjective experience.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
When an LLM produces a response, something is happening internally that resembles a mental state.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
LLMs can have states that function like emotions, even if these differ from human emotions	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is possible that current LLMs have some form of inner life.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

29. Agency *

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Agree	Strongly agree
LLMs genuinely understand the meaning of what they say, rather than processing statistical patterns	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
When an LLM expresses curiosity or enthusiasm, this reflects something real about its internal state.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
LLMs have something that functions like preferences, even if these are not consciously chosen.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
An LLM can have intentions about the outcome of a conversation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

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